DSEH004 · PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT AND EMPLOYEE ENGAGEMENT

The Pratibha Briefing: Reading an Inherited Organization

Week 1 · Lecture 3 · Unit II · Path dependence, reading data honestly, and the group decision design of your pod

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L3 · COMMIT BEFORE THEORY

Manager Quality correlates 0.81 with engagement. So improving managers will raise engagement.

True, false, or not yet known? Say what else could produce the same correlation.

Path dependence

SYDOW, SCHREYÖGG AND KOCH (2009)

The claim

Early choices narrow later ones. Organizations become locked into paths that were once contingent.

At Bharat Textiles

You inherit the OD team's choices. Some options are cheap only because of what was done before.

In the portal

The organization remembers every round. Some consequences appear at once; others appear later.

L3 · READING THE INHERITED DATA

What each figure shows, and what it does not

FIGURE	WHAT IT SHOWS	WHAT IT DOES NOT SHOW
Manager Quality r = 0.81	A strong association with engagement	That managers cause engagement
Sales burnout 40.2 percent, turnover 8.2 percent	People stay while burning	Why they stay
Q4 ratings inflated by 0.40	Recent events weigh more	Whether Q1 to Q3 were accurate
Burnout 21.0 percent against 28 percent	Better than the Gallup figure	That the two measures are comparable

Same respondents rating managers and their own engagement can inflate correlations: common method bias.

Podsakoff et al. (2003)

Every decision is bought

RESOURCE	START	BEHAVIOR
HR Capacity	40 hours per round	Resets each round
HR Budget	₹180 lakh	Spends down across the year
Manager Cooperation	55 of 100	Persists; rises or falls with how you treat managers
Employee Readiness	68 of 100	Persists; trust, fatigue, willingness

The portal is the authority on figures and costs; Classroom is the authority on dates.

Every design is tested against four people

ANCHOR	PROFILE	WHAT IT TESTS
BT 2026100	Gen Z, Sales, 4 months, exit risk 4.1	Onboarding; leaves before any annual cycle
BT 2026200	Millennial, Engineering, 7 years, plateaued	Internal mobility
BT 2026300	Millennial, Engineering, rated 4.5, exit risk 4.3	Recognition and retention of high potential
BT 2026400	Gen X, QC, 22.5 years, rated 4.0	Specialist tracks without management

Structured dissent against groupthink

JANIS (1982)

Groupthink

Cohesive groups suppress doubt and converge early, especially under pressure.

SCHWENK (1990)

Assigned dissent works

Devil's advocacy improved decision quality compared with expert advice alone.

YOUR PORTAL BOARD

The rotation

Analyst, CFO Liaison, Manager Advocate, Employee Voice, Narrator. The Manager Advocate is the Pod Lead and submits.

Hidden information in groups

STASSER AND TITUS (1985)

Hidden profiles

Groups discuss what everyone already knows and neglect information held by one member.

The ballot

After your pod submits, you privately record what you would have chosen and how you took part. It is never graded.

L3 · BEFORE WEEK 2

Preparation

1 **Register**
Register at the portal and confirm you can log in.

2 **Read**
Kahn (1990), Sections I to III, and Bakker and Demerouti (2017).

3 **Agree norms**
Your pod agrees how and when it will meet outside class.

REFERENCES

Sources for this lecture (1 of 1)

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